

made his inquiry Blanks quietly replied in a low, even tone, "You are looking at the man who killed your cousin now. I am the man." His quiet, cool manner was too much for Chambers who turned away and took the train back to Boley, and so far as know, Blanks was the only man who ever completely bluffed Chambers out.

Blanks owned a stock of general merchandise at Clearview and was also engaged in farming. He owned quite a bunch of cattle and some good teams, being rather well-to-do financially. Among the lawless element of negroes he had quite a number of enemies, but it was not known that this fact worried him any. The cause of his mental troubles can only be guessed at, but that his mind was seriously affected is almost a certainty, and had been noticed by many of his friends for several weeks. This fact accounts for his attempted attack on the colored druggist at Clearview last Wednesday evening, the only time he has ever been involved in personal trouble so far as is known, although a number of witnesses testified that he was known in the Clearview community as a violent, quarrelsome and dangerous man, and that he had threatened to kill not only his wife, but a number of men whom he seemed to have under suspicion.

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